



World's first NFT museum

The world's first permanent NFT art museum opened in Seattle, aiming to "pull back the curtain" NFT art. <https://digit.in/may22-07>



Chip shortage could continue

Intel CEO Pat Gelsinger says he expects the global semiconductor shortage to drag on until 2024. <https://digit.in/may22-08>

Biggest tech acquisitions

These are the biggest, most expensive tech acquisitions of all time

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E

lon Musk now owns Twitter! Even for the richest person in the world, a \$44 billion bid proved chal-

lenging as Elon loaned a big portion of the amount from third-party investors. We will see the Musk-Twitter transaction details down below. And while we are at it, let's look at some of the biggest acquisitions in the tech space.

TOP TECH ACQUISITIONS OF ALL TIME

Starting from the top of the ladder:

1 Activision was acquired by Microsoft for ~\$68 billion

To date, the biggest deal in the tech industry is the acquisition of Activision Blizzard by Microsoft. It is the biggest ever in the gaming sector too. The deal involved Microsoft paying \$95.00 per share while making it the world's third-largest gaming company by revenue.

2 EMC Corporation was bought by Dell for \$67 billion

Close to the Microsoft deal price is Dell's payment of \$67 billion to acquire the EMC corporation back in 2015. For the time, it was a surprising amount of money involved. With this new property, Dell strengthened its corporate computing and especially IT services.

3 Twitter acquisition by Elon Musk for ~\$44 billion

In 2022, Elon Musk offered to buy Twitter at \$54.20 per share price. Announcing the deal, Twitter revealed

that Musk has secured \$25.5 billion of the total \$44 billion amount through debt and margin loan financing while he is also committing \$21 billion in equity. He aims to make the platform more welcoming of free speech.

4 SoftBank bought Arm in 2016 for \$31 billion

Softbank completed the Arm acquisition for a whopping \$31 billion in 2016. This was the biggest deal for a European tech company. Since then, it has announced its plans to take the British firm public after the whole Arm Nvidia deal collapsed.

5 Slack was acquired by Salesforce for ~\$28 billion

In 2020, Salesforce closed the deal of acquiring Slack for \$27.7 billion. Although Slack's user experience didn't see much change, it is believed to have improved Salesforce's competitive advantage against the likes of Microsoft and Google in the business communication space.

6 LinkedIn was bought by Microsoft for ~\$26 billion

While the above deals are relatively recent, this and the latter one still lurks in our memory. Microsoft completed the deal for \$26.2 billion in 2016. The Windows maker had promised a bunch of enhancements to LinkedIn such as integration with the Office suite of apps and an "Intelligent Newsfeed". While some of the changes are live on the career networking platform, not all have been implemented.

7 WhatsApp acquisition by Facebook for \$19 billion

This one had sent waves across the whole tech world, especially in markets like India wherein WhatsApp is the go-to instant messaging app. Although the deal value was \$16 billion in early 2014, by the time it went

through, the price surged to \$22 billion in October 2014. Today, the Meta (formerly Facebook) branded apps are ever more integrated and dominant in the markets like ours.

8 Google bought Motorola Mobility for \$12.5 billion

What started off as a collaborative endeavour eventually became a case of acquisition for Google. This was back in 2011 when the old Moto G and X series of Motorola phones were the talk of the town. The silicon valley giant had paid around \$12.5 billion (or \$40 per share) in cash. Although this made sense to the whole stock Android software market, it didn't pan out as planned and Google sold the brand to Lenovo.

9 Skype purchased by Microsoft for \$8.5 billion

Skype is so popular that it became a verb. So when Microsoft took ownership of Skype in 2011, it was headlining news. The Redmond, Washington-based company has since introduced other video calling and messaging services like Teams, but Skype still holds a special place in tech culture.

10 GitHub acquired by Microsoft for \$7.5 billion

The coders amongst you would definitely recall this deal wherein Microsoft took reins of Github for \$7.5 billion. "We strengthen our commitment to developer freedom, openness and innovation," said Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella at the deal announcement.

There are other famous mergers and acquisitions that may not have made this list but are still important. For instance, Microsoft bought Nokia for \$7.2 billion, YouTube was grabbed by Google for \$1.65 billion, and Instagram was acquired by Facebook for \$1 billion. We are sure more such big-scale deals will happen in the future and we will be keeping tabs on the same. 